



Reels are YouTube's stories

Reels will be available to view beyond 24-hours, as common on similar features on other platforms. <http://digit.in/ReelsYT>



Google launches Datally app

Datally tracks data usage in real time, gives data saving recommendation, nearby public Wi-Fi notifications. <http://digit.in/GDatally>

Unwired

W

ho loves wires? No, there is no -philia word for wires, we checked. Unless you've got a particu-

lar obsession with ductility, it is unlikely that you are a big fan of things connected to each other with physical cords. One of the biggest culprits are charging cables. Almost everyone in the industry has tried their hand at innovating the same MagSafe, Micro-USB and even type-C, until the actual solution was finally upon us - wireless charging. Even that is hardly popular right now with few consumer devices actually supporting it. Why is that the case? Is there something wrong with how it has come to be? Let's find out.

WHY NOW

For a long time, people wouldn't really need to think about wireless charging. Why? Because most of the electronic devices we owned were not intended to be portable. They were firmly rooted in our homes and offices, comfortably plugged into a power supply. Now, almost everything an average person operates in their day to day life comes with a battery powered alternative. However, carrying around a charging cable for every device (even with popular standards such as Micro-USB and now type-C, device manufacturers don't play well with each other) can be cumbersome. Hence, the world needs wireless charging right now. But a long time back, we were still trying our best to make wireless charging happen due to sheer curiosity.

EARLY DAYS

If you go looking for the one person who invented wireless electricity

or charging, you'll have a tough job. There are no prizes for guessing who is the most popular name in the lot. After most of the 19th century was spent in establishing the existence and true nature of electromagnetic waves, Nikola Tesla started experimenting

demonstrations over a comparatively limited range, Tesla failed to make his advancements a commercial success - although today quite a few of his ideas power a number of modern devices. That didn't stop the geek idol from dreaming even bigger.



An artists representation of Tesla's World Wireless System - the searchlights are actually power flows

with wireless electricity transmission using inductive and capacitive coupling. The devices he used to do so were essentially electrical resonant transformer circuits, now popularly known as Tesla coils.

He even improved upon his initial achievements like using a receiving LC circuit tuned to resonance with the transmitter's LC circuit using resonant inductive coupling to increase distance. Even after successful public

He envisioned a plan to transmit electricity around the world wirelessly using the ionosphere as a conductor. His grand vision, the 'World Wireless System' to transmit power and information was unveiled in 1900, and was followed by the construction of the Wardencliff tower in New York as one of many such towers to

be built around the world. Eventually, investment dried up in 1904 and the project had to be abandoned.

MODERN DAYS

Fast forward to very beginning of the 21st century, Samsung was taking a lead in developing wireless charging technology for its consumers by actually setting up a dedicated team to work on it. The same team realised soon enough that for the process they

We've been familiar with wireless charging for a while now, so why aren't we bringing it home yet?

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